DIU THESIS GUIDELINES

A COMPLETE GUIDE FOR THESIS

(PREPARATION, TIMEFRAME, REQUIREMENTS, FORMAT, & SUBMISSION)

DEPARTMENT OF SOFTWARE ENGINEERING

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INTRODUCTION

This guidebook describes in detail the procedures and format for thesis preparation before submitting your thesis.

As you begin to prepare your thesis following the guidelines given, we would like to emphasize that the Department of Software Engineering of Daffodil International University upholds the policy of ensuring that all students pursuing the bachelor/master degrees are trained to practise the highest standards of intellectual honesty and integrity. Ideas and data of other researchers that you have used must be duly acknowledged in your thesis by citing and listing full details of the quoted materials in the reference list. Failure to do this will make you liable for plagiarism. Please remember that a writer may unconsciously commit plagiarism but nonetheless, it does not absolve him/her from the charge.

In view of the severity of plagiarism (*Udergraduate not more than 40%, Masters not more than 30%*), upon submission of two (2) copies of their theses for examination, the Department of Software Engineering of Daffodil International University requires that all graduate students sign a form declaring the originality of their research work and that it has not been submitted or published elsewhere.

STEP BY STEP GUIDE TO THESIS SUBMISSION (INFOGRAPHIC)

Step by step guide from proposal to final submission with time frame

How to submit the thesis/project proposal

NOTICE OF THESIS (DRAFT/FINAL) SUBMISSION (INFOGRAPHIC)

Internal and External Report according to PLO

List of Correction Submission (Form 1 for Pre-defense and Form-2 for Final)

STUDENT'S THESIS COPYRIGHT AND UNIVERSITY'S INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

The copyright to a thesis belongs to the student. However, as a condition of being awarded the degree, the student hereby grants to the University, a free, ongoing, non-exclusive right to use the relevant work and/or thesis for the University's teaching, research and promotional purposes as well as free and the non-exclusive right to retain, reproduce, display and distribute a limited number of copies of the thesis, together with the right to require its publication for further research and archival use.

WRITING STYLE

The following styles are accepted by DIU. Please refer to your program for the preferred style. Please browse the corresponding websites on how to use a particular style. You are required to use the adopted style consistently throughout the thesis.

APA

• Publication Manual of the American Psychological Association (APA Style Manual). 5th ed. Washington: American Psychological Association, 2001.

• http://owl.english.purdue.edu/owl/resource/560/01/ APA Formatting & Style Guide at Purdue University Online Writing Lab.

• Using American Psychological Association (APA) Format - Purdue University Online Writing Lab.

Footnotes and Endnotes

• Lehigh University Libraries. Footnote and Citation Style Guide.

http://www.lehigh.edu/library/footnote/footnote.html.

LAYOUT AND ARRANGEMENT OF CONTENT

Thesis Template for Bachelor and Master

LAYOUT AND FORMAT FOR SLIDE PREPARATION

Generalize PPT Format for Defense (Can Edit except font size and contrast)

THESIS FORMAT BULLETINS

Length of Thesis

• A Bachelor thesis should not exceed 30,000 words and Master thesis should not exceed 50,000 words.

Printing

•All printed copies must be clean and legible

• Use 80 gm, A4 size (210 x 297 mm), and white paper.

• Print on one side of the paper only.

• Computer paper or carbon copy is NOT allowed.

• Final copies must be laser printer.

Cover

• The cover (2 hardbound copies) must contain the following:

- Full thesis title

- Your full name

- The University name “DAFFODIL INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY”

- Year of submission

- Printed in gold, a font size of 18, Times New Roman or Arial and capitalized.

Binding

• The final 2 copies must be bound in black for Bachelor thesis and red for Master thesis, buckram or rexine with stiff boards.

• The spine must contain:

- Full thesis title
- Your full name
- Degree (Bachelor or Master)
- All lettering is printed in gold, capitalized with the appropriate font size (Times New Roman or Arial)
- Year of submission

Label for the CD cover

• The CD must have the following on the label:

- Full name
- Full thesis title
- Year of submission
- Degree

Typing format

• All narratives, tables, and graphs must be typeset and NOT handwritten.

Spacing

• Double spacing for text.

• Single spacing for text in long tables, table titles, long quotations, notes, footnotes, multiline caption and reference entries.

Symbols

• Please use appropriate software to generate symbols or special characters not found on the computer keyboard. Typed on one side.

• Use Times New Roman (font size 12) or Arial (font size 11)

• For formula, use an equation editor including subscripts and superscripts.

• Please observe proper convention for scientific names.

Margins

All Text, Tables, Figures and their captions must conform to the following margins:

• Top edge : 2.5 cm

• Bottom edge : 2.5 cm

• Right side : 2.5 cm

• Left side : 4.0 cm

The area below the bottom margin should be left blank except for footnotes.

A new paragraph must have at least 2 full lines on a page. Otherwise, begin on the next page.

PAGINATION

The Title page of the thesis is considered as page (i), but the number is not typed.

Pagination

• All page numbers are without punctuation.

• Place the page number 1 cm from the bottom Centre of a page.

• Preliminaries are numbered in lower case Roman numerals.

• All text and reference pages are numbered in Arabic numerals.

• All pages including those with diagrams, tables, etc. must have a page number.

• Appendices are labelled with an alphabet e.g. Appendix A with or without page numbering.

Subdivision

• Text in each chapter may be divided into headings and sub-headings such as 1.1, 1.2, 1.3 etc., 1.1.1, 1.1.2 etc. and 1.1.1(a), 1.1.2(a)

• All subdivisions begin from the left margin.

Notes and Footnotes

• Font sizes for notes and footnotes must be smaller than the font size used in the general text.

• The use of footnotes is not encouraged for the Sciences, Engineering, Medical, and Business and should be kept to a minimum.

As a general guideline, we suggest that you refer to the stylebook used in the thesis template for tables, figures, and plates. The following are just the basic guidelines.

Tables

• A table must be properly centered within the margins. The task should be numbered in relation to the chapter, e.g. in Chapter 1, tables should be numbered as Table 1.1, Table 1.2 etc.

• Numbered in Arabic numerals (Table 1.1, Table 1.2 etc.) with a caption.

• The number must correspond with text.

• Place tables near to related discussion in text.

• Place the heading above the table.

• Single-space all tables.

• Align all of the decimals in any column.

• Tables that are too large to fit the margins may be reduced to a smaller size of the same font style. The table number and title should be in the same font size as the rest of your manuscript. Format all tables consistently throughout, including the appendix tables.

• Tables that are too long or too wide for a single page (vertically or horizontally) may be continued on to the following page. The heading should be e.g. “Table 1-1. Continued” (do not repeat the table title). Column and row headings must be repeated for continued tables.

• Notes (if any) belong in the bottom row of the table. Do not vertically list your table notes (at the bottom of the table) but let them wrap automatically, like a paragraph text (do not put a hard return after each entry).

Figures

• Figures refer to illustrations, photographs, graphs or anything other than tables and script.

• Line diagrams should be drawn with the aid of a computer or with mechanical aids using black permanent ink or equivalent on white paper.

• Unless necessary, the use of color in graphs and figures is discouraged.

• Put heading below the figures.

• Put only 1 blank line space between the figure and figure heading.

• Minimize clutter. Label subparts of figures as A and B, not (A) and (B).

• If a figure and all its subparts run across more than one page, the entire figure heading (including descriptions of all subparts) must appear at the bottom of the first page of the figure. Any additional pages of subparts of this figure get only this heading at the bottom of the page.

APPENDIX A

References

DIU does not impose any restriction on the citation styles for your thesis. However, you are required to follow strictly to the style that you have chosen. The most common citation style is the Harvard style and below are examples of Harvard style presentations according to the information source.

Book

Family name, first initial. (Year) Title. City of publication: Publisher. Page number of your quotation Adams, A.D. (1906} Electric transmission of waterpower. New York: McGraw. P.1

British Standards Institution (1990) BS5605:1990 Recommendations for citing and referencing published material. Milton Keynes: BSI.

Coffin, J M. (1999) Molecular Biology of HIV. In: K.A. Crandell, (ed). The Evolution of HIV, Baltimore: Johns Hopkins Press.Pp.3-4.

Website with no author

Title of a website (Year as appearing on site) [Online]. [Date accessed]. Available from World Wide Web Feminist Collections A Quarterly of Women's Studies Resources (2002) [Online], [Accessed 9th May 2002]. Available from World Wide Web: http://www.library.wisc.edu/1ibraries/Womens Studies/fcmain.html

Website with no author

Family name, first initial(s) (Year) Title [Online]. [Date accessed]. Available from World Wide Web

Hawking, S. (2000) Professor Stephen Hawking's website [Online].[Accessed 9th May 2002]. Available from World Wide Web: http://www.hawking.org.uklhome/hindex.html

Thesis

Use the title page of the thesis:

Family name, first initial(s). (Year) Title. Type of qualification, academic institution Gill, M.R. (1997) the relationship between the physical properties of human articular cartilage and tissue biochemistry and ultrastructure. PhD thesis, University of Leeds.

Chapter in an edited book

Use the title page and reverse title page of the book and the chapter heading itself: Family name, first initial. (Year) Chapter title. In: initial Family name of the editor, (eds). Title of book. City of publication: Publisher. Page number of your quotation.

Patent

This information is found on the title page of the patent: Name of the originator. (Year) Title of patent document. Patent code. Patent number Philip Morris INC. (1981) Optical perforating apparatus and system. European patent application 0021165 A1. 1981-01-07

Standard

This information is found on the title page of the standard:

Author of the standard. (Year). Standard Number and Year (separated by a colon). Title of Standard. Place of publication and Name of a publisher (separated by a colon).

Conference Paper

Family name, first initial(s). (Year) Title of paper. In: Editor(s) of conference proceedings if known. Title of a conference, date of the conference, location of the conference. Place of publication: publisher. Page number(s).

Robertson, J. (1986) The economics of local recovery: In the Other Economics Summit, 17/18 April 1986, Tokyo. London: The Other Economics Summit.

Electronic journal article

Use information from the website and the article:

Family name, first initial(s). (Year) Title of article. Journal title. [Online]. Volume (issue number) [Date accessed], a page number of your quotation. Available from World Wide Web

Royall C.P., B.L. Thiel & A.M. Donald. (2001) Radiation damage of water in environmental scanning electron microscopy. Journal of Microscopy. [Online]. 204(3), [Accessed 9th May 2002], p.185.Avail- able from World Wide Web: http://www.blackwell-synergy.com/

Journal article

Use the title page of the journal volume or issue and the article: Family name, first initial(s). (Year) Title of article. Journal title. Volume (issue number), a page number of your quotation Walker, J

R (1998) Citing serials: online serial publications and citation systems. Serials-Librarian, 33(3/4), p.343-356.

CD-ROM

Use the accompanying material: Title (Year). [CD-ROM]. City of publication: Publisher.

Who's who 1987-1998 electronic resource {1998) [CD-ROM] London: Oxford University Press.

(Source: http://www.leeds.ac.ukllibrary/training/referencing/harvard.htm)

GUIDELINES FOR LIBRARY CLEARANCE

- ✓ Acceptable similarity range should be 40% for undergraduate and 30% for Master students.
- ✓ Plagiarism will be considered with less than 3% from single source for both Bachelor and Master.
- ✓ Reports will be checked a maximum of twice free of cost on behalf of library. For the 3rd or onwards, one hundred takas (Tk.100) only will have to be deposited to the Accounts Section.
- ✓ To receive "Plagiarism Clearance" from DIU library, one must send his/her Project report to the following email address: projectreport@diu.edu.bd and keep your supervisor in CC to be recommended in reply.
- ✓ Apply through Internship Portal https://internship.daffodilvarsity.edu.bd/ User ID and Password is the same as Student Portal.
  *FIVE field must be completed (Student's ID, Name, Supervisor Name, Title and Department).

  *** No report will be received without recommendation of concerned Supervisor.

DOWNLOADABLE LINK:

1. STEP BY STEP GUIDE PROPOSAL TO THESIS SUBMISSION.
2. HOW TO SUBMIT A PROPOSAL.
3. INTERNAL/EXTERNAL EXAMINER REPORT.
4. LIST OF CORRECTION FORM.
5. THESIS TEMPLATE.
6. PPT FORMAT.